

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Genetic Counselor

Jan 2026 - Present

General Surgery Outpatient Department

Sir Thutob Namgyal Memorial (STNM) Hospital, Gangtok, Sikkim

- Counseling patients with various kinds of cancer.
- Assessing family history and pedigree, hereditary risk assessment and recommendation.

Consultant Medical Writer

Sep 2024 - Jan 2025

IBD Patient Support Foundation (India)

- Research and writing for patient-centered educational resources disseminated via print and social media

EDUCATION

Certificate course on Genetic Counselling

Feb - Apr 2025

St John's Medical College Hospital, Bangalore

Course Guide: Dr Veronica Preetha Tilak

- Assisted on 70+ cases across gynecology, pediatrics, neurology and oncology.

Bachelor of Science, Cancer Biology, GPA - 9.0/10

2020 - 2024

School of Allied Healthcare and Sciences, Jain (Deemed-to-be) University

BSc Dissertation Project

2023 - 2024

Dissertation Title: Evaluating Epigenetics Modifications in Senescence

Supervisor: Dr Shovamayee Maharana, Assistant Professor

Department of Microbiology and Cell Biology, Indian Institute of Science

Summary: With aging many changes happen at cellular levels, one of which is changes in epigenetic markers such as acetylation and methylation. The goal of the project was to investigate what happens to these markers in senescence models. The studies were done in Bromodeoxyuridine (BrdU) induced cellular senescence models with young cells being control stained with activating and repressing markers antibody.

INTERNSHIPS

Vydehi Institute of Medical Sciences and Research Centre, Bangalore

Dec 2022

- Outpatient department rotation under senior medical oncologists.
- Diagnosing, assessing and planning treatment options for the patients.
- *Pathology*: Immunohistochemistry for detecting cancer markers: p53, CD20+, HER2 etc.
- *Genetics lab*: PCR based diagnostic tests to diagnose HIV, Hep B, Malaria, Dengue, Covid-19 etc.
- *Cytology*: Diagnosis-based Fluorescent in-situ hybridization and Karyotyping.

Imperial Cancer Centre, Apollo Hospitals, Bangalore

July - Aug 2022

- *Key diagnostics experiments*: Immunohistochemistry, Immunocytochemistry
Complete Blood Count, Urine Analysis, Blood Smear, Blast Count
Biomarkers detection such as Alpha Fetoprotein, CA19-9 etc.
Arterial Blood Gas, Antibiotic Susceptibility Tests,
Antinuclear Antigen Tests, Bacterial Streaking etc.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Genetic Risk Assessment & Pedigree Analysis
Molecular Diagnostics & Genetic Testing
Cancer Genetics & Hereditary Syndromes
Variant Interpretation & Reporting

Prenatal & Reproductive Genetics
Cytogenetics & Chromosomal Analysis
Ethical, Legal, and Psychosocial Aspects
Research & Translational Genetics

AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS

- Chief Minister Education Assistance Scholarship for pursuing BSc Cancer Biology
- 2nd Place - National Science Day Poster Presentation, 2023

VOLUNTEERING

- Executive Officer, Voluntary Blood Donors Association, Sikkim (East District)
 - *Recognition*: Active Working Member during Covid-19, 2020

REFERENCES

Dr Shovamayee Maharana

Assistant Professor, Microbiology and Cell Biology, Indian Institute of Science

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